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Electric kettle and power supply unit

Abstract

An electric kettle has a kettle body and a power supply unit that is configured to supply power to the kettle body. The power supply unit has a power supply base, a mounting unit and a first detection part. The power supply base is configured such that the kettle body is placed on top thereof, and has a power supply connection part that is configured to be electrically removably connected to a power receiving connection part. The mounting unit is configured such that a battery pack is removably coupled thereto as an external power source for supplying power to a heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part. The first detection part is configured to detect that the power supply unit is on a plane.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED ART

(1) The present application claims priority to Japanese Patent Application No. 2020-199410 filed on Dec. 1, 2020, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present disclosure relates to an electric kettle including a kettle body and a power supply unit, and to a power supply unit.

BACKGROUND

(3) Electric kettles for boiling water in a container with a heating device provided in the container are known. Japanese Unexamined Patent Application Publication No. 2012-80990 discloses an electric kettle in which a battery for supplying power to a heating device is mounted to a rear part of a container. The electric kettle of JP2012-80990A may be too heavy as a whole to be easy to handle, depending on the amount of water in the container and the weight of the battery. It is therefore desired to provide an electric kettle that is easier to handle.

SUMMARY

(4) According to a first aspect of the present disclosure, an electric kettle is provided. The electric kettle has a kettle body and a power supply unit. The kettle body has a power receiving connection part and a heating part. The power receiving connection part is configured to receive power from an external power source, and the heating part is configured to heat liquid contained in the kettle body by the power the power receiving connection part receives. The power supply unit is configured such that the kettle body is placed thereon, and is configured to supply power to the kettle body. The power supply unit has a power supply base, a mounting unit and a first detection part. The power supply base is configured such that the kettle body is placed on top thereof. The power supply base has a power supply connection part that is configured to be electrically removably connected to the power receiving connection part. The mounting unit is configured such that a battery pack is removably coupled thereto as the external power source. The mounting unit is configured to supply power of the mounted battery pack to the heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part. The first detection part is configured to detect that the power supply unit is on a plane (flat surface).

(5) According to this aspect, the power supply unit has the mounting unit configured such that the battery pack can be removably coupled thereto, which facilitates handling of the kettle body, compared with a structure in which the battery pack is coupled to the kettle body. Further, with the structure in which the battery pack can be coupled to the power supply unit, a user can use the electric kettle at a desired place, so that the degree of freedom of the use environment of the electric kettle is enhanced. Furthermore, the power supply unit has the first detection part configured to detect that the power supply unit is on a plane, so that the placing state of the power supply unit (whether the power supply unit is on a plane) can be detected. The plane (flat surface) may be, e.g., an at least substantially flat surface of a desk, a floor, or the ground.

(6) According to a second aspect of the present disclosure, a power supply unit is provided which is configured such that a kettle body is placed thereon, and configured to supply power to the kettle

body. The power supply unit has a power supply base, a mounting unit and a first detection part. The power supply base is configured such that the kettle body is placed on top thereof. The power supply base has a power supply connection part that is configured to supply power to the kettle body. The mounting unit is configured such that a battery pack is removably coupled thereto to supply power to the kettle body via the power supply connection part. The first detection part is configured to detect that the power supply unit is on a plane (flat surface).

(7) According to this aspect, the power supply unit has the mounting unit configured such that the battery pack can be removably coupled thereto, which facilitates handling of the kettle body, compared with a structure in which the battery pack is coupled to the kettle body. Further, with the structure in which the battery pack can be coupled to the power supply unit, a user can use the electric kettle at a desired place, so that the degree of freedom of the use environment of the electric kettle is enhanced. Furthermore, the power supply unit has the first detection part configured to detect that the power supply unit is on a plane, so that the placing state of the power supply unit can be detected.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an electric kettle **1** with a battery pack **100** mounted thereon.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the electric kettle **1** with a kettle body **10** removed from a power supply unit **50**.
- (3) FIG. 3 is an enlarged perspective view of a power supply connection part **72**.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a front view of the electric kettle **1** with the battery pack **100** mounted thereon.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a right side view of the electric kettle **1** with the battery pack **100** mounted thereon.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a left side view of the electric kettle **1** with the battery pack **100** mounted thereon.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a top view of the electric kettle **1** with the battery pack **100** mounted thereon.
- (8) FIG. 8 is a back view of the electric kettle **1** with the battery pack **100** mounted thereon.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a sectional view of the electric kettle **1**, taken along line IX-IX in FIG. 5.
- (10) FIG. 10 is a sectional view of the electric kettle **1**, taken along line X-X in FIG. 4.
- (11) FIG. 11 is a top view of the power supply unit **50** with the battery pack **100** mounted thereon.
- (12) FIG. 12 is a bottom view of the power supply unit **50** with the battery pack **100** mounted thereon.
- (13) FIG. 13 is a sectional view taken along line XIII-XIII in FIG. 12.
- (14) FIG. 14 is a top view of the electric kettle **1**.
- (15) FIG. 15 is a back view of the electric kettle **1**.
- (16) FIG. 16 shows an example of the battery pack **100**.
- (17) FIG. 17 is a bottom view of the kettle body **10**.
- (18) FIG. 18 is a block diagram showing the system configuration of the electric kettle **1**.
- (19) FIG. 19 is a block diagram showing the system configuration of an electric kettle **1a** according to a second embodiment.
- (20) FIG. 20 is a perspective view of an electric kettle **1e** according to a third embodiment.
- (21) FIG. 21 shows an example of a second display part **150** of the electric kettle **1e**.
- (22) FIG. 22 is a perspective view of an electric kettle **1b** according to a fourth embodiment.
- (23) FIG. 23 is a schematic view of an electric kettle **1c** according to a fifth embodiment.
- (24) FIG. 24 is a schematic view of an electric kettle **1d** according to a sixth embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(25) In one, non-limiting embodiment of the present disclosure, the first detection part may include a switch provided in a lower surface of the power supply unit. The switch may be configured to protrude from the lower surface when the power supply unit is not on the plane, while being

pushed into the lower surface when the power supply unit is on the plane.

(26) According to this embodiment, whether the power supply unit is on a plane is detected with a simple structure.

(27) In addition or in the alternative to the preceding embodiments of the present disclosure, the electric kettle may further have a first control part. The first control part may be configured to control power supply to the heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part based on a detection result of the first detection part. The first control part may be configured to supply power to the heating part when at least one predetermined condition is satisfied, and configured not to supply power to the heating part when the at least one predetermined condition is not satisfied. The at least one predetermined condition may include that the power supply unit is on the plane.

(28) According to this embodiment, the first control part does not execute power supply to the heating part when the power supply unit is not on a plane. Thus, when the power supply unit is moved away from the plane, power is not supplied to the heating part, so that the safety of the electric kettle is enhanced. Accordingly, the safety of the electric kettle 1 is ensured while the degree of freedom of the use environment of the electric kettle is enhanced.

(29) In addition or in the alternative to the preceding embodiments, the electric kettle may further have a second detection part. The second detection part may be configured to detect that the kettle body is on the power supply base.

(30) According to this embodiment, whether the kettle body is on the power supply base is detected.

(31) In addition or in the alternative to the preceding embodiments, the first control part may be further configured to control power supply to the heating part based on a detection result of the second detection part. The at least one predetermined condition may include that the kettle body is on the power supply base.

(32) According to this embodiment, the first control part does not supply power to the heating part when the kettle body is not on the power supply base. Thus, power is not supplied to the heating part when the power supply connection part is exposed even if the power supply unit is on a plane, so that the safety of the electric kettle is further enhanced.

(33) In addition or in the alternative to the preceding embodiments, the electric kettle may further have an indication part and a second control part. The indication part may be configured to indicate drive information of the electric kettle. The second control part may be configured to control the indication part based on a detection result of the first detection part. The second control part may be configured to cause the indication part to indicate, as the drive information, that the power supply unit is not on the plane when the power supply unit is not on the plane.

(34) According to this embodiment, when the power supply unit is not on a plane, the indication part informs (notifies) the user of this information, thereby urging the user to place (put) the power supply unit on a plane. Further, the user can know the reason why heating of liquid in the kettle body does not start. Thus, the electric kettle is provided with high convenience.

(35) In addition or in the alternative to the preceding embodiments, the second control part may be further configured to control the indication part, based on a detection result of the second detection part. The second control part may be configured to control the indication part based on a detection result of the second detection part. The second control part may be configured to cause the indication part to indicate, as the drive information, that the kettle body is not on the power supply base when the kettle body is not on the power supply base.

(36) According to this embodiment, when the kettle body is not on the power supply base, the indication part informs the user of this information, thereby urging the user to place the power supply unit on a plane. Further, the user can know the reason why heating of liquid in the kettle body does not start. Thus, the electric kettle is provided with high convenience.

(37) In addition or in the alternative to the preceding embodiments, the second control part may be

further configured to detect a residual capacity of the battery pack via the mounting unit. The second control part may be configured to cause the indication part to indicate, as the drive information, that the (detected) residual capacity of the battery pack is not more than a predetermined residual capacity when the detected residual capacity of the battery pack is not more than the predetermined residual capacity.

(38) According to this embodiment, when the residual capacity of the battery pack is a predetermined residual capacity or less, the indication part informs the user of this information. Thus, the electric kettle is provided with high convenience for the user.

(39) In addition or in the alternative to the preceding embodiments, the power supply unit may have a grip part. The grip part may extend upward from the power supply base and be configured to be held by a user.

(40) According to this embodiment, the user can hold the grip part and carry the power supply unit alone or carry the kettle body and the power supply unit together. Thus, the electric kettle is provided with high convenience for the user.

(41) In addition or in the alternative to the preceding embodiments, the power supply base and the mounting unit may be respectively arranged on opposite sides of the grip part.

(42) According to this embodiment, the possibility that liquid to be used for the electric kettle adheres to the mounting unit can be reduced, so that the safety and durability of the electric kettle is improved.

(43) The technique of the present disclosure can also be realized in various applications other than an electric kettle and a power supply unit, such as a power supply unit having a battery pack, an electric kettle having a battery pack, a control device for an electric kettle, a controlling method for an electric kettle, a controlling method for a power supply unit, and computer programs for a computer to execute these controlling methods.

First Embodiment

(44) <Structure of the Electric Kettle>

(45) An electric kettle **1** according to a first embodiment of the present disclosure is described with reference to FIGS. **1** to **18**. The electric kettle **1** includes a kettle body **10** and a power supply unit **50**. A user of the electric kettle **1** places the kettle body **10** containing liquid such as water, on a power supply base **70** of the power supply unit **5** having an external power source mounted thereon and turns ON a main switch **S1** that is provided in the power supply unit **50** in order to boil liquid in the kettle body **10**. A battery pack **100** is mounted on the electric kettle **1** shown in FIGS. **1** and **4** to **8** and the power supply unit **50** shown in FIG. **11**. The battery pack **100** is an example of the external power source of the electric kettle **1**.

(46) In the following description, for convenience sake, the up-down direction of the electric kettle **1** is defined with reference to the attitude of the kettle body **10** of the electric kettle **1** placed on the power supply unit **50**. Specifically, the side on which the kettle body **10** is placed on the power supply unit **50** is an upper side of the electric kettle **1**, while the opposite side is a lower side of the electric kettle **1**. Further, an extension direction of an axis that is orthogonal to the up-down direction and that intersects the kettle body **10** and a mounting unit **90** for mounting the battery pack **100** is defined as a front-rear direction. In the front-rear direction, the side on which the mounting unit **90** is arranged on the power supply unit **50** is defined as a rear side, while the side on which the kettle body **10** is arranged is defined as a front side. A direction orthogonal to the up-down direction and the front-rear direction is defined as a left-right direction.

(47) <Structure of the Power Supply Unit>

(48) The power supply unit **50** is configured such that the kettle body **10** is placed thereon, and configured to supply power to the kettle body **10**. In this embodiment, the power supply unit **50** mainly includes a base part **60**, a wall part **80** and the mounting unit **90**. The power supply unit **50** can be formed of metal or resin (polymer). The wall part **80** is a generally plate-like member extending upward from the base part **60**.

(49) As shown in FIG. 2, the base part **60** is a generally plate-like member extending in the front-rear direction and the left-right direction. A lower surface **63** of the base part **60** can be (placed) on a table (or a desk), floor or ground.

(50) The power supply base **70** is provided in a region of the base part **60** on a front surface **81** side of the wall part **80**. The power supply base **70** is configured such that a bottom part **40** of the kettle body **10** is placed thereon. A lower surface **41** of the kettle body **10** is placed on an upper surface **71** of the power supply base **70**. In this embodiment, the upper surface **71** of the power supply base **70** is located below an upper end of a side wall **62** of the base part **60**. The area of the power supply base **70** is slightly larger than the area of the bottom part **40** of the kettle body **10**. A power supply connection part **72** is provided substantially on a central portion of the upper surface **71** of the power supply base **70**. As shown in the perspective view of FIG. 2, the sectional views of FIGS. 9 and 10 showing the electric kettle **1** and the top view of FIG. 11 showing the power supply unit **50**, the power supply connection part **72** protrudes upward from the upper surface **71**. The power supply connection part **72** is configured such that a power receiving connection part **42** (described below) of the kettle body **10** is fitted thereon. As shown in FIG. 3, in this embodiment, the power supply connection part **72** has a generally truncated conical shape having a bottom on the lower side and has a pair of notches **79** formed (recessed) from a side face **72s** of the truncated conical part toward the center. A power supply connection terminal **73** that is a conductive member is provided in each of the notches **79**. The power supply connection terminal **73** supplies power to the kettle body **10** from the battery pack **100** mounted on the mounting unit **90**.

(51) As shown in FIGS. 12 and 13, a bottom switch **133** is provided in the lower surface **63** of the power supply unit **50**. The lower surface **63** of the power supply unit **50** shown in FIG. 13 is not placed (situated, located) on a plane (flat surface). The bottom switch **133** is of a push-in type. In this embodiment, the bottom switch **133** includes a button **134** and a button receiver **135**. The button **134** and the button receiver **135** are configured to be movable in the up-down direction. The button **134** protrudes downward from the lower surface **63** of the base part **60** while the lower surface **63** is not on a plane. The button receiver **135** is arranged above the button **134** to face the button **134**. The button **134** is configured to be pushed into the lower surface **63** of the base part **60** so as not to protrude downward from the lower surface **63** of the base part **60**, in response to the lower surface **63** of the base part **60** being placed (put, mounted) on a plane. The plane refers to, for example, an at least substantially flat (even) surface (e.g., the top surface of a desk, a floor surface, or a ground surface). The button receiver **135** is configured to be pushed upward by the button **134** when the lower surface **63** of the power supply unit **50** is placed (put, mounted) on a plane and the button **134** is pushed in upward. The button receiver **135** is configured to transmit an ON signal to a control part **66** (described below) when a lower surface of the button **134** is substantially flush with the lower surface **63** of the base part **60**. When the lower surface **63** of the power supply unit **50** is moved away from the plane, the button **134** and the button receiver **135** move downward. As a result, the ON signal from the button receiver **135** to the control part **66** is cut off (in other words, the bottom switch **133** is turned OFF). The bottom switch **133** serves as a detection part for detecting whether the power supply unit **50** is placed on a plane (flat surface) (or whether the power supply unit **50** is being situated/located on a plane).

(52) In this embodiment, the power supply base **70** further has the following structure.

(53) As shown in FIG. 3, the notch **79** has a pair of faces **79s** connected to the side face **72s**, and a face **79c** connecting the faces **79s**. The faces **79s** are substantially parallel to each other in the up-down direction and are opposed across the power supply connection terminal **73**. An upper end of each of the faces **79s** is located below an upper face **72u** of the power supply connection part **72**. The upper end of the face **79s** is connected to the upper face **72u** via an inclined face **79g**. The inclined face **79g** is inclined toward the power supply connection terminal **73**. The inclined face **79g** serves as a guide to move the kettle body **10** in the circumferential direction such that a power receiving connection terminal **45** of the kettle body **10** is connected to the power supply connection

terminal **73**, which will be described in detail below.

(54) The side face **72s** of the power supply connection part **72** is shaped to conform to a side face **42s** (see FIG. **17**) of the power receiving connection part **42** (described below) of the kettle body **10**. Specifically, the power supply connection part **72** is configured such that the kettle body **10** can be moved in the circumferential direction while the side face **42s** of the power receiving connection part **42** can be moved along the side face **72s** of the power supply connection part **72**. Further, the power supply connection part **72** is configured to restrict rotation of the kettle body **10** when fitted in the power receiving connection part **42** of the kettle body **10**. To restrict rotation herein means that the kettle body **10** is hardly movable in the circumferential direction when placed on the power supply base **70**. Being hardly movable means that the kettle body **10** is movable only within a range in which the power receiving connection terminal **45** is held electrically connected to the power supply connection terminal **73**. It can also be said that the power supply connection part **72** is configured such that the kettle body **10** cannot rotate when the power supply connection part **72** is fitted in the power receiving connection part **42** of the kettle body **10**.

(55) As shown in FIGS. **10** and **11**, a pair of terminals (first energizing terminals **131**) are provided in the upper surface **71** of the power supply base **70**. The first energizing terminals **131** are closer to an outer edge of the power supply base **70** in the radial direction, than to the power supply connection part **72** and arranged substantially symmetrically to the power supply connection part **72**. The first energizing terminals **131** are respectively arranged in positions to be connected to second energizing terminals **132** (see FIG. **17**) provided in the lower surface **41** of the kettle body **10** when the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**. In this embodiment, the first energizing terminals **131** are electrically connected to the second energizing terminals **132** when the power supply connection part **72** of the power supply base **70** is fitted in (into) the power receiving connection part **42** of the kettle body **10**.

(56) As shown in FIGS. **2**, **11** and **12**, the power supply base **70** has through holes **77** formed through the power supply base **70** in the up-down direction. In this embodiment, the through holes **77** are closer to an outer edge of the power supply base **70**, i.e., closer to the outer edge of the power supply base **70** in the radial direction, than to the power supply connection part **72**. It can also be said that the through holes **77** are closer to the side wall **62** of the base part **60** and the wall part **80**. In this embodiment, four such through holes **77** are provided and arranged substantially symmetrically to the power supply connection part **72**.

(57) As shown in FIGS. **9** and **10**, the upper surface **71** of the power supply base **70** has an inclined surface **74** inclined downward from the power supply connection part **72** toward the outside (outer edge) of the power supply base **70**.

(58) As shown in FIGS. **1**, **2** and **4** to **7**, a rib **75** is formed in front of the power supply base **70** and protrudes upward from the power supply base **70**. The rib **75** is formed in a position to face the front surface **81** of the wall part **80**. The rib **75** is shaped to conform to the outer edge of the power supply base **70** and an outer peripheral surface **31** (described below) of the kettle body **10**. The rib **75** restricts forward movement of the kettle body **10** placed on the power supply base **70**. In this embodiment, an upper end of the rib **75** in the up-down direction is located above a lower end of a kettle grip part **23** (described below) of the kettle body **10** on the power supply base **70**.

(59) The wall part **80** is now described. In this embodiment, the wall part **80** is a generally plate-like member extending in the up-down direction and the left-right direction. The wall part **80** extends upward from the power supply base **70**. The power supply base **70** is provided in a region on the front surface **81** side of the wall part **80**, and the mounting unit **90** is provided in a region on a rear surface **82** side of the wall part **80**. In this embodiment, the wall part **80** separates the region for the power supply base **70** and the region for the mounting unit **90**.

(60) The wall part **80** has a power supply unit grip part **85** that is arranged above the mounting unit **90** and configured to be held (gripped, grasped) by the user. The power supply unit grip part **85** is shaped with a through hole extending through the wall part **80** in the front-rear direction. It can also

be said that the power supply unit grip part **85** is provided between the mounting unit **90** and the kettle body **10** on the power supply base **70** in the front-rear direction. An upper end of the power supply unit grip part **85** protrudes above the kettle body **10** on the power supply base **70**. In this embodiment, the electric kettle **1** is configured such that the center of gravity of the electric kettle **1** is located on or near the wall part **80** irrespective of the amount of liquid in the kettle body **10** when the battery packs **100** are mounted on the mounting unit **90** and the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**. Thus, the power supply unit grip part **85** is arranged directly above the center of gravity of the electric kettle **1**.

(61) As shown in FIGS. **2** and **11**, the wall part **80** has a recessed part **83** formed in the front surface **81** and recessed from the front surface **81** toward the rear surface **82**. The recessed part **83** is shaped to conform to the outer peripheral surface **31** of the kettle body **10**.

(62) As shown in FIGS. **8** and **15**, a first display part **86** is provided on the rear surface **82** of the wall part **80**. In this embodiment, the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** is displayed on the first display part **86**, which will be described in detail below.

(63) The battery pack **100** to be mounted on the mounting unit **90** and the mounting unit **90** are now described with reference to FIGS. **14** to **16**.

(64) The battery pack **100** is an example of an external power source to be coupled to (mounted on) the mounting unit **90**. The battery pack **100** is, for example, a battery pack having a nominal voltage of 18 volt and can be used as a power source of the electric kettle **1**.

(65) The battery pack **100** may also be called as a battery package or an assembled battery, and has an outer shell housing formed into a prescribed size and a plurality of lithium ion battery cells that are housed in the outer shell housing and connected in series. The battery pack **100** is a rechargeable battery pack and can be recharged by a charger (not shown) after used as an external power source. The battery pack **100** is a so-called slide-type battery pack and can be removably coupled to (mounted on) the mounting unit **90** or a charger.

(66) In FIG. **16**, the up-down direction, the front-rear direction and the left-right direction are shown with reference to the attitude of the battery pack **100** mounted on the mounting unit **90**. The battery pack **100** has a pair of left and right rail receiving parts **101**. A positive output terminal **102** and a negative output terminal **103** are arranged between the rail receiving parts **101**. A connector part **104** is arranged between the positive output terminal **102** and the negative output terminal **103** and configured to transmit and receive control signals to and from a charger and other devices. A lock member **105** is provided on an upper part of the battery pack **100**. A spring member (not shown) is arranged below the lock member **105** within the housing of the battery pack **100**. The spring member biases the lock member **105** to press the lock member **105** upward. An unlock button **106** (see, for example, FIG. **11**) is arranged on a rear surface of the battery pack **100**. When the unlock button **106** is pressed downward, the lock member **105** moves downward.

(67) As shown in FIGS. **14** and **15**, the mounting unit **90** is arranged on the rear surface **82** side of the wall part **80**. In this embodiment, the mounting unit **90** is provided on a lower part of the rear surface **82** of the wall part **80**. The mounting unit **90** has two mounting parts **91** having the same structure and electrically connected in series to each other. The mounting unit **90** is configured to connect in series two battery packs **100**, for example, each having a nominal voltage of 18 volt. The electric kettle **1** can be driven with power supplied from the mounting unit **90** having the two battery packs **100** mounted thereto.

(68) The mounting part **91** has a pair of slide rails **92**. In this embodiment, the slide rails **92** extend in the up-down direction. A positive input terminal **93** and a negative input terminal **94** are arranged on the slide rails **92**. The mounting part **91** further has a lock receiving hole **95** that is engageable with the lock member **105** of the battery pack **100**.

(69) The rail receiving parts **101** are engaged with the slide rails **92** and the battery pack **100** is mounted onto the mounting part **91** by sliding the battery pack **100** in a mounting direction relative to the mounting part **91**. In this embodiment, the mounting direction is from up to down. When the

battery pack **100** is mounted onto the mounting part **91**, the positive input terminal **93** and the negative input terminal **94** of the mounting part **91** are electrically connected to the positive output terminal **102** and the negative output terminal **103** of the battery pack **100**. Further, when the battery pack **100** is mounted onto the mounting part **91**, the lock member **105** is engaged with the lock receiving hole **95** and the battery pack **100** is locked so as not to move in the up-down direction.

(70) When a user presses down the unlock button **106** of the battery pack **100** mounted onto the mounting part **91**, the lock member **105** is disengaged (unlocked) from the lock receiving hole **95**. When the battery pack **100** is slid in a removing direction relative to the mounting part **91** in the unlocked state, the battery pack **100** is removed from the mounting part **91**. In this embodiment, the removing direction is from down to up. Thus, the battery pack **100** can be removably mounted onto the mounting part **91** of the mounting unit **90**.

(71) <Structure of the Kettle Body>

(72) As shown in FIGS. **1** to **2** and **4** to **10**, the kettle body **10** has appearance mainly having a body unit **20** and a lid **21**. The body unit **20** has a bottomed hollow cylindrical shape having an open top. The lid **21** is connected to the body unit **20** and configured to open and close the open top of the body unit **20**. The body unit **20** has a side wall part **30**, a bottom part **40** and a liquid containing part **48**.

(73) The side wall part **30** is a generally hollow cylindrical part extending in the up-down direction of the body unit **20**. The side wall part **30** forms the outer peripheral surface **31** of the kettle body **10**. A spout **22** for pouring liquid from the liquid containing part **48** is formed in an upper end part of the side wall part **30**. The kettle grip part **23** for holding the kettle body **10** is provided in a position opposed to the spout **22** when the kettle body **10** is viewed from above. Ends of the kettle grip part **23** are connected to upper and lower end parts of the side wall part **30**. The side wall part **30** and the kettle grip part **23** can be formed of metal or resin.

(74) The bottom part **40** is a part connected to the lower end of the side wall part **30**. The bottom part **40** can be formed of metal or resin. The power receiving connection part **42** is provided on the center of the lower surface **41** of the bottom part **40**. As shown in the sectional views of FIGS. **9** and **10** showing the electric kettle **1** and the bottom view of FIG. **17** showing the kettle body **10**, the power receiving connection part **42** protrudes upward from the lower surface **41**. The power receiving connection part **42** is configured to be fitted on the power supply connection part **72** of the power supply unit **50**. In this embodiment, the power receiving connection part **42** has a generally truncated conical shape having a bottom on the lower side and has a pair of plate-like members **44** protruding from a side face of the truncated conical part toward the center. The power receiving connection terminal **45** that is a conductive member is provided on each of the plate-like members **44**. The power receiving connection terminal **45** receives power from an external power source via the power supply connection part **72**. In this embodiment, the power receiving connection part **42** is configured to restrict movement of the kettle body **10** in cooperation with the power supply connection part **72** of the power supply unit **50** when fitted on the power supply connection part **72**.

(75) In this embodiment, each of the plate-like members **44** has a gap extending substantially in the up-down direction and configured such that the power supply connection terminal **73** can be inserted therein. The power receiving connection terminal **45** is provided on a pair of faces **44s** of the plate-like member **44** that define the gap. When the kettle body **10** is positioned relative to the power supply connection part **72** in the circumferential direction such that the plate-like members **44** are fitted in the notches **79** (see FIG. **3**), the power receiving connection terminals **45** are connected to the power supply connection terminals **73**, respectively, and movement of the kettle body **10** is restricted.

(76) In this embodiment, as described above, each of the notches **79** of the power supply connection part **72** has the inclined face **79g** inclined downward from the upper face **72u** of the

power supply connection part 72 toward the power supply connection terminal 73. When the plate-like member 44 of the kettle body 10 is located on the inclined face 79g, the kettle body 10 moves downward along the inclined face 79g under its own weight and the plate-like member 44 is fitted in the notch 79. Thus, in the electric kettle 1 according to this embodiment, positioning of the kettle body 10 relative to the power supply unit 50 is completed when the plate-like member 44 is placed on the notch 79 or the inclined face 79g in the circumferential direction. Even if the plate-like member 44 is not placed on the inclined face 79g, a user can move the kettle body 10 in the circumferential direction to place the plate-like member 44 on the inclined face 79g. Thus, the kettle body 10 moves downward along the inclined face 79g under its own weight, so that the positioning of the kettle body 10 is completed.

(77) Further, in this embodiment, the lower surface 41 of the bottom part 40 of the kettle body 10 has an inclined face 46 inclined downward and radially outward from the power receiving connection part 42. The inclined face 46 is shaped to conform to the inclined surface 74 of the power supply base 70. Thus, the kettle body 10 is stably placed on the power supply base 70.

(78) As shown in FIG. 17, a pair of terminals (the second energizing terminals 132) are provided in the lower surface 41 of the kettle body 10. The second energizing terminals 132 are closer to an outer edge of the lower surface 41 in the radial direction, than to the power receiving connection part 42 and arranged substantially symmetrically to the power receiving connection part 42. The second energizing terminals 132 are respectively arranged in positions to be connected to the first energizing terminals 131 (see FIGS. 10 and 11) provided in the upper surface 71 of the power supply base 70 when the kettle body 10 is placed on the power supply base 70. The second energizing terminals 132 are electrically connected to the first energizing terminals 131 when the power supply connection part 72 of the power supply base 70 is fitted in (into) the power receiving connection part 42 of the kettle body 10.

(79) The liquid containing part 48 is provided inside of the side wall part 30 and the bottom part 40. The liquid containing part 48 is shaped such that liquid such as water can be stored inside. An inner surface of the liquid containing part 48 may be coated with heat-resistant resin such as fluororesin. A bottom of the liquid containing part 48 is formed of heat conductive materials such as metal.

(80) As shown in FIG. 9, a temperature sensor Tc for measuring the temperature of liquid in the liquid containing part 48 is provided on a bottom of the liquid containing part 48. In this embodiment, a circuit for the temperature sensor Tc is formed (activated, worked, completed, closed) by contact (connection) between the first energizing terminals 131 and the second energizing terminals 132. Specifically, in the electric kettle 1, when the kettle body 10 is placed (put, mounted) on the power supply base 70, the second energizing terminals 132 get into contact with the first energizing terminals 131, and then the temperature of liquid in the liquid containing part 48 can be measured. The first energizing terminals 131, the second energizing terminals 132 and the temperature sensor Tc also serve as a detection part for detecting whether the kettle body 10 is on the power supply unit 50. The measurement result of the temperature sensor Tc is transmitted to the control part 66 described below.

(81) As shown in FIG. 10, a heater 49 is installed in the bottom part 40. The heater 49 receives power via the power receiving connection part 42 and heats liquid in the liquid containing part 48 (directly) above the bottom part 40. The structure of the kettle body 10 described in this embodiment is just an example. The kettle body 10 may have a known structure except a structure in which power is received from the power supply unit 50 having the mounting unit 90.

(82) <System Configuration>

(83) One example of the system configuration of the electric kettle 1 is now described. As shown in FIG. 18, in this embodiment, the power supply unit 50 has a control device (control unit, control circuit, circuitry) 65. The control device 65 of this embodiment is configured as a microcomputer, having a CPU, a memory. The control device 65 (specifically, CPU) is configured to implement various functions to serve as control part 66 by executing programs stored in the memory. The

control part **66** controls the various operations of the electric kettle **1** using the detection results of the above-described parts or components. Examples of various controls of the control part **66** are now described.

(84) The control part **66** is configured to obtain an ON signal from the bottom switch **133** when the bottom switch **133** is pushed. When the control part **66** obtains an ON signal of the bottom switch **133** (in other words, the ON signal is output to the control part **66** from the bottom switch **133**), it means that the power supply unit **50** is placed on a plane. On the other hand, when the control part **66** does not obtain an ON signal of the bottom switch **133**, it means that the power supply unit **50** is not on a plane.

(85) The control part **66** is configured to obtain a measurement result of the temperature sensor **Tc** when the circuit for the temperature sensor **Tc** is formed (activated, completed, closed) by contact between the first energizing terminals **131** and the second energizing terminals **132**. When the control part **66** obtains a measurement result of the temperature sensor **Tc**, it means that the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**. On the other hand, when the control part **66** does not obtain a measurement result of the temperature sensor **Tc**, it means that the kettle body **10** is not on the power supply base **70**.

(86) The control part **66** is configured to obtain information relating to the voltage of the battery pack **100** via the mounting unit **90**. The control part **66** calculates the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** by using a predetermined relation between the voltage and the residual capacity. In this embodiment, the control part **66** displays information indicating the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** on the first display part **86** (see FIG. **15**).

(87) Next, the power supply control to the heater **49** performed by the control part **66** is described. The control part **66** supplies power to the heater **49** via the power supply connection part **72** and the power receiving connection part **42** when predetermined conditions are satisfied. In this embodiment, the predetermined conditions include three conditions: (i) that the power supply unit **50** is on a plane; (ii) that the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**; and (iii) that the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** is a predetermined residual capacity or more. The predetermined residual capacity in this embodiment is a capacity required to boil a prescribed amount of water (liquid) within the kettle body **10**. When all the three conditions are satisfied, i.e., when (i) the power supply unit **50** is on a plane, (ii) the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**, the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** is a predetermined residual capacity or more, and (iii) the control part **66** controls the power supply unit **50** to supply power to the heater **49**. For example, when the power supply unit **50** is being carried by a user, or when the kettle body **10** is not on the power supply base **70**, the control part **66** does not supply power to the heater **49**.

(88) Further, the control part **66** is configured to inform (notify) the user of drive information of the electric kettle **1**. In this embodiment, the drive information includes three kinds of information; (i) that the power supply unit **50** is not on a plane; (ii) that the kettle body **10** is not on the power supply base **70**; and (iii) that the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** is not more than the predetermined residual capacity. In this embodiment, the main switch **S1** (e.g., a pushbutton) is provided with a light that is lighted when the main switch **S1** is turned ON. Further, the power supply unit **50** has a sound output part **141** configured to output sound. The control part **66** controls the light of the main switch **S1**, the sound output part **141** and the first display part **86** to indicate the drive information. For example, when the main switch **S1** is ON and the power supply unit **50** is not on a plane, the control part **66** blinks the light of the main switch **S1** and/or outputs attention (caution) sound from the sound output part **141**. The control part **66** may change the color and the blinking time of the light of the main switch **S1**, the duration of the attention sound, and combinations thereof.

(89) In this embodiment, the control part **66** is configured to stop power supply to the heater **49** while keeping the main switch **S1** ON when the predetermined conditions are not satisfied, and to restart power supply to the heater **49** if the above-described conditions are satisfied again within a

predetermined time period after the stop. Further, the control part **66** is configured to turn OFF the main switch **S1** if the above-described conditions are not satisfied even if a predetermined time elapses after power supply to the heater **49** is stopped while the main switch **S1** is kept ON. The predetermined time is, for example, any one of time periods of one to five seconds. Provision of such a structure of the electric kettle **1** allows a user to lift the power supply unit **50**, or lift the kettle body **10** from the power supply base **70**, for a relatively short time during power supply to the heater **49**, thereby improving convenience for the user. The control part **66** may be configured to control the main switch **S1** and the sound output part **141** to indicate the above-described drive information during the above-described predetermined time, thereby urging the user to place the power supply unit **50** on a plane or to place the kettle body **10** on the power supply base **70**.

(90) Further, in this embodiment, the control part **66** is configured to obtain a predetermined set temperature. The control part **66** is configured to control to heat the liquid in the liquid containing part **48** up to the set temperature by using the measured value obtained from the temperature sensor **Tc** and the set temperature. The set temperature may be set by a user, for example, by using a temperature setting part **67** provided in the power supply unit **50** (see FIG. **18**). The temperature setting part **67** is an input interface by which a user can set a temperature. Further, the predetermined set temperature may be stored in the memory of the control device **65** in advance. For example, the boiling temperature of the liquid may be stored as the set temperature in the memory.

(91) <Effects>

(92) According to the above-described first embodiment, the electric kettle **1** has the following effects.

(93) (A1) The power supply unit **50** has the mounting unit **90** configured such that the battery pack **100** can be removably coupled thereto (mounted thereon), which facilitates handling of the kettle body **10**, compared with a structure in which the battery pack **100** is coupled to the (mounted thereon) kettle body **10**. Further, with the structure in which the battery pack **100** can be coupled to (mounted on) the power supply unit **50**, a user can use the electric kettle **1** at a desired place, so that the degree of freedom of the use environment of the electric kettle **1** is enhanced.

(94) (A2) The bottom switch **133** is provided in the lower surface **63** of the power supply unit **50**, and configured to protrude from the lower surface **63** when the power supply unit **50** is not on a plane, while being pushed into the lower surface **63** when the power supply unit **50** is on a plane. Thus, whether the power supply unit **50** is on a plane is detected with a simple structure.

(95) (A3) The control part **66** is configured to supply power to the heater **49** when the predetermined conditions including that the power supply unit **50** is on a plane are satisfied. Accordingly, power is not supplied to the heater **49** when the power supply unit **50** is not on a plane. This reduces the possibility that water or other liquid in the kettle body **10** is boiled to generate high temperature steam, for example, while a user is carrying the electric kettle **1** (the power supply unit **50**). Thus, the electric kettle **1** is provided which offers a high level of safety while enhancing the degree of freedom of the use environment.

(96) (A4) The electric kettle **1** has the first energizing terminals **131** provided in the upper surface **71** of the power supply base **70** and the second energizing terminals **132** provided in the lower surface **41** of the kettle body **10**. The circuit for the temperature sensor **Tc** is formed (activated, completed, closed) by electric connection between the first and second energizing terminals **131**, **132**. In other words, the circuit for the temperature sensor **Tc** is activated when terminals **131** and terminals **132** come into contact with each other. With this structure, it can be detected whether the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70** depending on whether a measurement result of the temperature sensor **Tc** is obtained.

(97) (A5) In this embodiment, the predetermined conditions for supplying power to the heater **49** include that the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**. Accordingly, the control part **66** does not supply power to the heater **49** when the kettle body **10** is not on the power supply base **70**.

Therefore, power is not supplied to the heater **49** when the power supply connection part **72** is exposed even if the power supply unit **50** is on a plane. This enhances the safety of the electric kettle **1** when a user unintentionally touches the power supply connection part **72** or when water or other liquid drops onto the power supply connection part **72**.

(98) (A6) When the power supply unit **50** is not on a plane, the control part **66** informs the user of this information, thereby urging the user to place the power supply unit **50** on a plane. Further, the user can know the reason why water or other liquid in the kettle body **10** is not heated. Thus, the electric kettle **1** is provided with high convenience.

(99) (A7) When the kettle body **10** is not on the power supply base **70**, the control part **66** informs the user of this information, thereby urging the user to place the kettle body **10** on the power supply base **70**. Further, the user can know the reason why water or other liquid in the kettle body **10** is not heated. Thus, the electric kettle **1** is provided with high convenience.

(100) (A8) The control part **66** stops power supply to the heater **49** while keeping the main switch **S1** ON when the predetermined conditions are not satisfied, and restarts power supply to the heater **49** if the above-described conditions are satisfied again within a predetermined time period after the stop. Further, the control part **66** turns OFF the main switch **S1** if the above-described conditions are not satisfied again within a predetermined time after the stop. Provision of this structure allows a user to lift the power supply unit **50**, or lift the kettle body **10** from the power supply base **70**, for a relatively short time during power supply to the heater **49**. Thus, the electric kettle **1** is provided with safety and convenience.

(101) (A9) When the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** is not more than a predetermined residual capacity or more, the control part **66** informs the user of this information. Thus, the electric kettle **1** is provided with high convenience for the user.

(102) (A10) The power supply unit **50** has the power supply unit grip part **85** extending upward from the power supply base **70** and configured to be held by a user. Therefore, the user can hold the power supply unit grip part **85** and carry the power supply unit **50** alone or carry the kettle body **10** and the power supply unit **50** together. Thus, the electric kettle **1** is provided with high convenience for the user.

(103) (A11) The power supply base **70** on which the kettle body **10** is placed is arranged on the first surface (the front surface **81**) side of the wall part **80** (the power supply unit grip part **85**), and the mounting unit **90** is arranged on the second surface (the rear surface **82**) side of the wall part **80**. Thus, the possibility that liquid to be used for the electric kettle **1** adheres to the mounting unit **90** can be reduced, so that the safety and durability of the electric kettle **1** is improved. Furthermore, when a user opens the lid **21** of the kettle body **10** and puts liquid into the kettle body **10** while leaving the kettle body **10** placed on the power supply base **70**, the possibility that the liquid also adheres to the mounting unit **90** or the battery pack **100** can be reduced. Thus, the safety and durability of the electric kettle **1** is improved, and the degree of freedom in handling of the electric kettle **1** is improved.

(104) (A12) The mounting unit **90** has the slide rails **92** extending in the up-down direction and configured such that the battery pack **100** is removably coupled thereto by sliding on the slide rails **92** in the up-down direction. Thus, even if the liquid in the kettle body **10** adheres to the slide rails **92**, the liquid can easily drop downward, so that the safety and durability of the electric kettle **1** is further improved.

(105) (A13) The power supply unit grip part **85** is arranged above the mounting unit **90** on the wall part **80**. Thus, the attitude of the electric kettle **1** can be stabilized with the battery pack **100** mounted on the rear surface **82** of the wall part **80** and with the kettle body **10** placed on the power supply base **70** on the front surface **81** side of the wall part **80**. Accordingly, the possibility of tilting of the electric kettle **1** can be reduced when the electric kettle **1** is carried by a user, so that the electric kettle **1** is provided which is easier to carry.

(106) In relation to the above-described effect (A13), in this embodiment, the electric kettle **1** is

configured such that the center of gravity of the electric kettle **1** is located on or near the wall part **80** irrespective of the amount of liquid in the kettle body **10** when the battery pack **100** is mounted on the mounting unit **90** and the kettle body **10** is placed on the power supply unit **50**. Thus, the power supply unit grip part **85** is arranged directly above the center of gravity of the electric kettle **1** in use, so that the electric kettle **1** is provided which is further easier to carry.

(107) (A14) The power supply unit **50** has the rib **75** protruding upward from the power supply base **70** and facing the front surface **81** of the wall part **80**. Thus, the possibility that the electric kettle **1** is displaced from the power supply base **70** can be reduced when the electric kettle **1** is carried, so that the electric kettle **1** is provided which is easier to carry.

(108) (A15) The power supply base **70** has the through holes **77** formed through the power supply base **70** in the up-down direction. Thus, even if the liquid adheres to the power supply base **70**, the liquid can be discharged through the through holes **77**. Accordingly, the possibility that the liquid stays on the power supply base **70** can be reduced, so that the safety and durability of the electric kettle **1** is further improved.

(109) (A16) The power supply base **70** includes the inclined surface **74** inclined downward from the central portion of the upper surface **71** toward the outer edge of the power supply base **70**. Thus, even if liquid adheres to the power supply base **70**, the liquid is discharged toward the outside. Further, the through holes **77** are arranged closer to the outer edge of the power supply base **70** than to the central portion of the power supply base **70**. Thus, the liquid that can flow toward the outer edge is discharged through the through holes **77** arranged close to the outer edge. Accordingly, the possibility that the liquid stays on the power supply base **70** can be further reduced, so that the safety and durability of the electric kettle **1** is furthermore improved.

(110) (A17) The wall part **80** of the power supply unit **50** has the recessed part **83** formed in the front surface **81** and recessed from the front surface **81** toward the rear surface **82** of the wall part **80**. The recessed part **83** is shaped to conform to the outer peripheral surface **31** of the side wall part **30** of the kettle body **10**. Thus, the user can place the kettle body **10** on the power supply base **70** along the recessed part **83**, so that the kettle body **10** is placed in a proper position.

(111) (A18) The power receiving connection part **42** of the kettle body **10** and the power supply connection part **72** of the power supply base **70** are configured to be fitted together when the kettle body **10** is placed on the power supply base **70**. The power receiving connection part **42** and the power supply connection part **72** are configured to restrict rotation of the kettle body **10** on the power supply base **70** when fitted together. Thus, power can be stably supplied from the power supply unit **50** to the kettle body **10**.

(112) (A19) The upper end of the rib **75** in the up-down direction is located above the lower end of the kettle grip part **23** of the kettle body **10** placed on the power supply base **70**. Thus, the user can place the kettle body **10** on the power supply unit **50** such that the kettle grip part **23** is located between the rib **75** and the wall part **80** in the front-rear direction. Further, in this embodiment, the power receiving connection part **42** and the power supply connection part **72** are configured to be fitted together within a range in which the kettle grip part **23** is located between the rib **75** and the wall part **80** in the front-rear direction. Thus, the rib **75** has a positioning function for properly placing the kettle body **10** on the power supply base **70** in cooperation with the wall part **80**. Accordingly, the user can easily place the kettle body **10** in a proper position.

Second Embodiment

(113) <Structure of the Power Supply Unit>

(114) An electric kettle **1a** according to a second embodiment of the present disclosure is described with reference to FIG. **19**. In the following description, components identical to those of the above-described embodiment are given the same numerals and not described. In the electric kettle **1a** of the second embodiment, a control device (unit) **65a** (CPU) of a power supply unit **50a** is configured to implement various functions to serve as control part **66a** by executing programs stored in the memory. The control device **65a** stores a predetermined relation between amounts of

liquid in the kettle body **10** and power required to heat each amount of the liquid up to a predetermined temperature. The control part **66a** calculates an actual amount of the liquid that can be heated up to the predetermined temperature based on the above-described relation and the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** that is obtained via the mounting unit **90**.

(115) A first display part **86a** displays the liquid amount calculated by the control part **66a**. An example of the display of the first display part **86a** is shown in FIG. **19**. The amount of liquid that can be contained in the liquid containing part **48** is shown by a scale, and the liquid amount calculated by the control part **66a** is shown cross-hatched. The electric kettle **1a** according to this embodiment is otherwise similar to the electric kettle **1** according to the first embodiment and will not be further elaborated here.

(116) <Effects>

(117) According to this embodiment, the user can put the displayed amount of liquid into the kettle body **10** in order to obtain the liquid heated up to the predetermined temperature by putting the displayed amount of liquid into the kettle body **10**, for example, even when the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** is small.

(118) The electric kettle **1a** according to this embodiment has the same structure as the electric kettle **1** according to the first embodiment except for the control part **66a** and the first display part **86a**. Therefore, the electric kettle **1a** according to this embodiment also has the same effects as the effects (A1) to (A19) of the first embodiment.

Third Embodiment

(119) An electric kettle **1e** according to a third embodiment of the present disclosure is described with reference to FIGS. **20** and **21**. The electric kettle **1e** is different from the electric kettle **1** according to the first embodiment in that a power supply unit **50e** has a switch **S2** and a second display part **150**. The switch **S2** is an input interface (a manipulation part) for setting a target (desired) temperature of liquid (to be heated) in the kettle body **10** and changing a unit of temperature to be displayed on the second display part **150**. The second display part **150** is configured to display (indicate) various kinds of information including the drive information of the electric kettle **1e**. The other components of the electric kettle **1e** according to this embodiment are similar to those of the first embodiment and will not be described here.

(120) Display of the second display part **150**, which is shown as an example in FIG. **21**, is now described. In the example shown in FIG. **21**, a set target temperature of the liquid to be heated in the kettle body **10** is displayed in a region **151** of the second display part **150**. The temperature of the liquid in the kettle body **10** is measured by the temperature sensor **Tc** and displayed in a region **152**. The unit of temperature is selected with the switch **S2** and displayed in a region **153**. The electric kettle **1e** is configured such that either centigrade or Fahrenheit can be selected as the temperature unit. Whether the power supply unit **50** is on a plane (flat surface) or not is displayed in a region **154**. For example, while the power supply unit **50** remains on the plane (i.e., while the bottom switch **133** is ON), the control part **66** continuously displays (i.e., without blinking) in the region **154** an icon indicating that the power supply unit **50** is on a plane. On the other hand, while the power supply unit **50** is not on a plane (i.e., while the bottom switch **133** is OFF), the control part **66** blinks this icon. Whether the kettle body **10** is on the power supply unit **50** (the power supply base **70**) or not is displayed in a region **155**. For example, while the kettle body **10** remains on the power supply base **70**, the control part **66** continuously displays in the region **155** an icon indicating that the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**. On the other hand, while the kettle body **10** is not on the power supply base **70**, the control part **66** blinks this icon.

(121) Information relating to the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** is displayed in a region **156**. For example, when the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** is less than a predetermined residual capacity, the control part **66** blinks an icon of a battery in the region **156**. At this time, the control part **66** may simultaneously cause the sound output part **141** to audibly indicate this information. An icon indicating that the heater **49** is being heated is displayed in a region **157**

during power supply to the heater **49**. An icon indicating whether output of sound from the sound output part **141** is permitted is displayed in a region **158**. A user can manually input with the switch **S2** whether to permit output of sound from the sound output part **141**.

(122) <Effects>

(123) In the electric kettle **1e** according to this embodiment, the second display part **150** visually indicates (displays) whether the power supply unit **50** is on a plane (flat surface) and whether the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**. This can further urge the user to place the power supply unit **50** on a plane or to place the kettle body **10** on the power supply base **70**. Further, the electric kettle **1e** according to this embodiment has the same structure as the electric kettle **1** according to the first embodiment except for having the second display part **150** and the switch **S2**. Therefore, the electric kettle **1e** according to this embodiment also has the same effects as the effects (A1) to (A19) of the first embodiment.

Fourth Embodiment

(124) <Structure of the Power Supply Unit>

(125) An electric kettle **1b** according to a fourth embodiment of the present disclosure is described with reference to FIG. 22. The electric kettle **1b** is different from the electric kettle **1** according to the first embodiment in that a mounting unit **90b** of a power supply unit **50b** does not have the slide rails **92**. In this embodiment, the mounting unit **90b** is configured such that a battery pack **100b** is coupled thereto via an electric cord **120b**.

(126) Specifically, in this embodiment, the battery pack **100b** has a battery body **110b** and the electric cord **120b** having one end connected to the battery body **110b**. The battery body **110b** includes a plurality of lithium ion battery cells connected in series. A connection end part **125b** is provided on the other end of the electric cord **120b** and has an insertion port for connection to the mounting unit **90b**. The mounting unit **90b** has a mounting part (not shown) configured such that the insertion port of the connection end part **125b** is plugged therein. The electric kettle **1b** according to this embodiment is otherwise similar to the electric kettle **1** according to the first embodiment and will not be further elaborated here.

(127) <Effects>

(128) According to this embodiment, the electric kettle **1b** has the same effects as the effects (A1) to (A11) and (A13) to (A19) of the first embodiment, excluding the effect (A12) relating to the slide rails **92** of the mounting unit **90** in the first embodiment.

Fifth Embodiment

(129) <Structure of the Power Supply Unit>

(130) An electric kettle **1c** according to a fifth embodiment of the present disclosure is described with reference to FIG. 23. In FIG. 23, main parts of the electric kettle **1c** that are not visible from the outside are shown by broken lines. A power supply unit **50c** of the electric kettle **1c** mainly includes a base part **60c** and a mounting unit **90c**. Unlike the electric kettle **1** according to the first embodiment, the power supply unit **50c** does not have the wall part **80** and the power supply unit grip part **85**. Further, the power supply unit **50c** has an acceleration sensor **133c** in place of the bottom switch **133**. The acceleration sensor **133c** detects movement of the power supply unit **50c**. In this embodiment, the control part **66** determines that the power supply unit **50c** is on a plane (flat surface) when movement of the power supply unit **50c** is not detected via the acceleration sensor **133c**.

(131) The base part **60c** separates a region for a power supply base **70c** and a region for the mounting unit **90c**. The power supply base **70c** is provided on an upper surface **61c** side of the base part **60c**. The power supply base **70c** is a portion of the upper surface **61c** of the base part **60c** that is recessed downward.

(132) The mounting unit **90c** is provided on a lower surface **63c** side of the base part **60c**. Two mounting parts **91c** are arranged in the mounting unit **90c**. Each of the mounting parts **91c** has a pair of slide rails (not shown). In this embodiment, the slide rails extend in the front-rear direction.

The battery pack **100** can be coupled to and removed from the mounting part **91c** by sliding the battery pack **100** in the front-rear direction relative to the slide rails. In the electric kettle **1c**, a surface of the battery pack **100** (a lower surface of the battery pack **100** in FIG. **23**) opposite to a surface thereof having the rail receiving parts **101** (see FIG. **15**) can be placed on a table (or a desk), floor or ground. The electric kettle **1c** according to this embodiment is otherwise similar to the electric kettle **1** according to the first embodiment and will not be further elaborated here.

(133) <Effects>

(134) In the electric kettle **1c** according to the fifth embodiment, the power supply unit **50c** has the mounting unit **90c** configured such that the battery pack **100** is removably coupled thereto, which facilitates handling of the kettle body **10**, compared with a structure in which the battery pack **100** is mounted on the kettle body **10**. Therefore, the electric kettle **1c** has the same effect as the above-described effect (A1) of the first embodiment.

(135) The power supply unit **50c** has the acceleration sensor **133c**, so that whether the power supply unit **50c** is on a plane (flat surface) can be detected via the acceleration sensor **133c**.

(136) The power supply base **70c** on which the kettle body **10** is placed is arranged on the first surface (the upper surface **61c**) side of the base part **60c**, and the mounting unit **90c** configured such that the battery pack **100** is mounted thereon is arranged on the second surface (the lower surface **63c**) side of the base part **60c**. Thus, the possibility that liquid to be used for the electric kettle **1c** adheres to the mounting unit **90c** can be reduced.

(137) The electric kettle **1c** according to the fifth embodiment is otherwise similar to the electric kettle **1** according to the first embodiment, and therefore has the same effect as the effects (A3) to (A9), (A11) and (A14) to (A19) of the first embodiment.

Sixth Embodiment

(138) <Structure of the Power Supply Unit>

(139) An electric kettle **1d** according to a sixth embodiment of the present disclosure is described with reference to FIG. **24**. In FIG. **24**, main parts of the electric kettle **1d** that are not visible from the outside are shown by broken lines. A power supply unit **50d** of the electric kettle **1d** mainly includes a base part **60d**, a mounting unit **90d** and a power supply unit grip part **85d**. Unlike the first embodiment, the power supply unit **50d** does not have the wall part **80**.

(140) A power supply base **70d** is provided on an upper surface **61d** side of the base part **60d**. The power supply base **70d** is a portion of the upper surface **61d** of the base part **60d** that is recessed downward. The mounting unit **90d** is provided on a side surface **62d** of the base part **60d**. Thus, the electric kettle **1d** according to this embodiment is different from the above-described embodiments in that the power supply base **70d** is arranged on the first surface (the upper surface **61d**) side of the base part **60d** and the mounting unit **90d** is provided on the side surface **62d** of the base part **60d**. A second surface (a lower surface **63d**) of the base part **60d** can be placed on a table (or a desk), floor or ground.

(141) The mounting unit **90d** has two mounting parts **91d**. The mounting parts **91d** are arranged side by side in the front-rear direction, and only one of the mounting parts **91d** is shown in FIG. **24**. Each of the mounting parts **91d** has a pair of slide rails (not shown). The battery pack **100** can be coupled to (mounted onto) the mounting part **91d** by sliding the battery pack **100** in the mounting direction relative to the slide rails.

(142) A power supply unit grip part **85d** extends upward from the power supply base **70d**. An upper end of the power supply unit grip part **85d** protrudes above the kettle body **10** placed on the power supply base **70d**.

(143) <Effects>

(144) According to this embodiment, the power supply unit **50d** has the mounting unit **90d** for mounting the battery pack **100** thereon, which facilitates handling of the kettle body **10**, compared with a structure in which the battery pack **100** is mounted on the kettle body **10**. Therefore, this embodiment also has the same effect as the effect (A1) of the first embodiment.

(145) Further, the power supply unit **50d** has the power supply unit grip part **85d**, so that the user can hold the power supply unit grip part **85d** and carry the power supply unit **50d** or carry the kettle body **10** and the power supply unit **50d** together.

(146) Correspondences between the features of the above-described embodiments and the features of the present disclosure are as follows, but the features of the embodiments are merely exemplary and the features of the present disclosure are not limited to them.

(147) The electric kettles **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** are examples of the “electric kettle”. The battery packs **100**, **100b** are examples of the “external power source” and the “battery pack”. The power receiving connection part **42** is an example of the “power receiving connection part”. The heater **49** is an example of the “heating part”. The kettle body **10** is an example of the “kettle body”. The power supply units **50**, **50a**, **50b**, **50c**, **50d**, **50e** are examples of the “power supply unit”. The power supply bases **70**, **70c**, **70d** are examples of the “power supply base”. The upper surface **71** is an example of the “upper surface of the power supply base”. The power supply connection part **72** is an example of the “power supply connection part”. The mounting units **90**, **90b**, **90c**, **90d** are examples of the “mounting unit”. The bottom switch **133** is an example of the “first detection part” and the “switch”. The acceleration sensor **133c** is an example of the “first detection part”. The first energizing terminal **131**, the second energizing terminal **132**, the temperature sensor **Tc** and the acceleration sensor **133c** are examples of the “second detection part”. The control parts **66**, **66a** are examples of the “first control part” and the “second control part”. The first display parts **86**, **86a**, the second display part **150**, the sound output part **141**, the main switch **S1** and the switch **S2** are examples of the “indication part”. The power supply unit grip parts **85**, **85d** are examples of the “grip part”. The front surface **81** is an example of the “first surface”. The rear surface **82** is an example of the “second surface”.

OTHER EMBODIMENTS

(148) The detection part for detecting whether the power supply unit **50**, **50a**, **50b**, **50c**, **50d**, **50e** is on a plane (flat surface) is not limited to the bottom switch **133** and the acceleration sensor **133c**. For example, a device for detecting movement or tilting of the power supply unit **50**, **50a**, **50b**, **50c**, **50d**, **50e**, including a gyro sensor, a tilt sensor and other vibration detection sensors, can be employed.

(149) In the above-described embodiments, whether the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**, **70c**, **70d** is detected by the first and second energizing terminals **131**, **132** respectively provided in the upper surface **71** of the power supply base **70**, **70c**, **70d** and the lower surface **41** of the kettle body **10**, and the temperature sensor **Tc**. However, other sensors or devices such as a switch that is capable of detecting whether the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**, **70c**, **70d** may be used. For example, a push-in type switch like the bottom switch **133** may be provided in the lower surface **41** of the kettle body **10** and configured such that an ON signal is transmitted from the kettle body **10** to the power supply unit **50**, **50a**, **50b**, **50c**, **50d**, **50e** when this switch is pushed.

(150) In the above-described embodiments, the control part **66**, **66a** executes power supply to the heater **49** when the predetermined conditions are satisfied. The predetermined conditions include (i) that the power supply unit **50**, **50a**, **50b**, **50c**, **50d**, **50e** is on a plane, (ii) that the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**, **70c**, **70d**, and (iii) that the residual capacity of the battery pack **100**, **100b** is a predetermined residual capacity or more. The predetermined conditions may however be at least any one of the above-described conditions (i), (ii), (iii), or that the main switch **S1** is turned ON.

(151) The structure of the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** may be appropriately changed. For example, the power supply base **70** need not have the inclined surface **74**. The power supply connection part **72** and the power receiving connection part **42** may have other shapes insofar as these parts are configured to be electrically connected to each other when the kettle body **10** is on the power supply base **70**.

(152) In the above-described embodiments, the kettle body **10** may be, for example, a kettle that is

configured to be placed on a commercial power supply unit connected to an AC power source.

(153) The through holes **77**, if provided in the power supply base **70**, **70c**, **70d**, may be closer to the power supply connection part **72** than to the outer edge of the power supply base **70**, **70c**, **70d**. This structure can also reduce the possibility that liquid to be used for the kettle body **10** stays on the power supply base **70**, **70c**, **70d**.

(154) The control device **65**, **65a** may be provided in the kettle body **10**. In this case, the kettle body **10** may be configured to obtain the residual capacity of the battery pack **100** and the set temperature via the power supply connection part **72** and the power receiving connection part **42** that are provided in the kettle body **10**. Like the control device **65**, **65a**, the first display part **86**, **86a**, the second display part **150**, the sound output part **141**, the main switch **S1** and the switch **S2** may also be provided in the kettle body **10**.

(155) The power supply unit **50** may be configured to include the mounting unit **90b** of the fourth embodiment. Specifically, the mounting unit **90** of the power supply unit **50** may be configured such that the battery pack **100** and the battery pack **100b** are selectively removably mounted thereto.

(156) The electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** may have a charging function. For example, the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** may have a connection part configured to be connected to an AC power source and be configured to charge the battery pack **100**, **100b** when the AC power source is connected to the connection part. The base part **60**, **60c**, **60d** may have a charging circuit for this charging, or a unit having a charging circuit may be provided in the middle of a cord for the AC power source.

(157) The electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** may be configured to wirelessly communicate with an external device, and various settings for the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** may be performed with the external device. For example, a portable terminal may be used which is capable of wireless communication and is provided with applications for driving the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** and performing the various settings such as temperature setting, and the control part **66**, **66a** of the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** may perform various controls according to instructions via the applications. Further, the control part **66**, **66a** may transmit the various settings (performed for the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d** by the user) and use history information of the electric kettle to the portable terminal via a communication part provided in the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**. For example, the control part **66**, **66a** may be configured to obtain signals from the main switch **S1**, the bottom switch **133**, the acceleration sensor **133c**, the first energizing terminals **131**, the second energizing terminals **132** and the temperature sensor **Tc**, and transmit to the portable terminal, information that the main switch **S1** of the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** has been turned ON, that the kettle body **10** has been lifted up from the power supply base **70**, **70c**, **70d**, or that the power supply unit **50**, **50a**, **50b**, **50c**, **50d**, **50e** has been moved away from the plane, if such is detected from the obtained signals.

(158) The electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** may have a detection part provided in the kettle body **10** to detect that the kettle body **10** is on a plane (flat surface), and may be further configured to detect based on the detection result of this detection part that the whole electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** is on a plane. For example, like the detection device provided in the power supply unit **50**, **50a**, **50b**, **50c**, **50d**, **50e** to detect that the power supply unit is on a plane, the kettle body **10** may have a device for detecting movement or tilting of the kettle body **10** (the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e**), including an acceleration sensor, a gyro sensor, a tilt sensor and other vibration detection sensors. Such a structure may be applied to detect whether the electric kettle **1**, **1a**, **1b**, **1c**, **1d**, **1e** is on a plane.

(159) Further, in view of the nature of the present disclosure and the above-described embodiments, the following aspects are provided. At least one of the aspects can be employed in combination with any of the above-described embodiments and the claimed invention.

(160) (Aspect 1)

(161) An electric kettle, comprising: a kettle body having a power receiving connection part configured to receive power from an external power source, and a heating part configured to heat liquid contained in the kettle body by the power the power receiving connection part receives; and a power supply unit configured such that the kettle body is placed thereon, and configured to supply power to the kettle body, the power supply unit including: a plate part having a first surface and a second surface; a power supply base that is arranged on a side of the first surface of the plate part and configured such that the kettle body is placed on top thereof, the power supply base having a power supply connection part that is configured to be electrically removably connected to the power receiving connection part; and a mounting unit that is arranged on a side of the second surface of the plate part and configured such that a battery pack is removably coupled thereto as the external power source for supplying power to the heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part.

(Aspect 2)

(162) The plate part is connected to the power supply base and extends upward from the power supply base, and the mounting unit is arranged on the second surface of the plate part.

(Aspect 3)

(163) The mounting unit has a rail that extends in an up-down direction and that is configured such that the battery pack is removably coupled thereto by sliding in the up-down direction.

(164) (Aspect 4)

(165) The plate part has a grip part that is provided above the mounting unit and configured to be held by a user.

(166) (Aspect 5)

(167) The power supply unit has a rib protruding upward from the power supply base and facing the first surface of the plate part.

(168) (Aspect 6)

(169) The power supply base has a through hole formed through the power supply base in the up-down direction.

(170) (Aspect 7)

(171) The power supply connection part is arranged on a central portion of an upper surface of the power supply base, the upper surface includes an inclined surface inclined downward from the central portion toward an outer edge of the power supply base, and the through hole is closer to the outer edge of the power supply base than to the central portion.

(Aspect 8)

(172) The plate part has a recessed part formed in the first surface and recessed from the first surface toward the second surface of the plate part, the recessed part being shaped to conform to a side peripheral surface of the kettle body placed on the power supply base.

(173) (Aspect 9)

(174) The electric kettle further comprises: a control part that is configured to calculate an amount of liquid that can be heated up to a predetermined temperature based on (i) a predetermined relation between amounts of the liquid in the kettle body and power required to heat each amount of the liquid up to the predetermined temperature and (ii) a residual capacity of the battery pack that is obtained via the mounting unit, and a display part that is provided on the power supply unit and configured to display the amount of the liquid calculated by the control part.

(Aspect 10)

(175) The power receiving connection part of the kettle body and the power supply connection part of the power supply base are configured to be fitted together when the kettle body is placed on the power supply base and to restrict rotation of the kettle body on the power supply base.

(176) (Aspect 11)

(177) An electric kettle, comprising: a kettle body having a power receiving connection part configured to receive power from an external power source, and a heating part configured to heat

liquid contained in the kettle body by the power the power receiving connection part receives; and a power supply unit configured such that the kettle body is placed thereon, and configured to supply power to the kettle body, the power supply unit including: a power supply base configured such that the kettle body is placed on top thereof, and having a power supply connection part that is configured to be electrically removably connected to the power receiving connection part; and a mounting unit that is configured such that a battery pack is removably coupled thereto as the external power source for supplying power to the heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part; and a grip part that extends upward from the power supply base and is configured to be held by a user.

(Aspect 12)

(178) The mounting unit is arranged in a position opposed to the kettle body placed on the power supply base across the grip part.

(179) (Aspect 13)

(180) The kettle body has a temperature sensor configured to measure a temperature of liquid contained in the kettle body, and the second detection part includes a first energizing terminal provided in the upper surface of the power supply base and a second energizing terminal provided in the lower surface of the kettle body, and the first energizing terminal and the second energizing terminal are arranged to be connected to each other when the kettle body is on the power supply base, and configured to form (activate, work, complete, close) an electronic circuit for the temperature sensor by the connection to each other.

(Aspect 14)

(181) A power supply unit that is configured such that a kettle body is placed thereon, and configured to supply power to the kettle body, the kettle body having a power receiving connection part configured to receive power from an external power source, and a heating part configured to heat liquid contained in the kettle body by the power the power receiving connection part receives, the power supply unit comprising: a plate part having a first surface and a second surface; a power supply base that is arranged on a side of the first surface of the plate part and configured such that the kettle body is placed on top thereof, the power supply base having a power supply connection part that is configured to be electrically removably connected to the power receiving connection part; and a mounting unit that is arranged on a side of the second surface of the plate part and configured such that a battery pack is removably coupled thereto as the external power source for supplying power to the heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part.

(182) In the foregoing embodiments, parts or all of the functions and processing implemented by software may be implemented by hardware. In addition, parts or all of the functions and process implemented by hardware may be implemented by software. As the hardware, for example, various circuits, such as an integrated circuit, a discrete circuit, or a combined circuit module thereof can be used.

DESCRIPTION OF THE REFERENCE NUMERALS

(183) **1, 1a, 1b, 1c, 1d, 1e** . . . electric kettle, **10** . . . kettle body, **20** . . . body unit, **21** . . . lid, **22** . . . spout, **23** . . . kettle grip part, **30** . . . side wall part, **31** . . . outer peripheral surface, **40** . . . bottom part, **41** . . . lower surface, **42** . . . power receiving connection part, **42s** . . . side face, **44** . . . plate-like member, **44s** . . . face, **45** . . . power receiving connection terminal, **46** . . . inclined face, **48** . . . liquid containing part, **49** . . . heater, **50, 50a, 50b, 50c, 50d, 50e** . . . power supply unit, **60, 60c, 60d** . . . base part, **61c, 61d** . . . upper surface, **62** . . . side wall, **63, 63c, 63d** . . . lower surface, **65, 65a** . . . control device, **66, 66a** . . . control part, **67** . . . temperature setting part, **70, 70c, 70d** . . . power supply base, **71** . . . upper surface, **72** . . . power supply connection part, **72s** . . . side face, **72u** . . . upper face, **73** . . . power supply connection terminal, **74** . . . inclined surface, **75** . . . rib, **77** . . . through hole, **79** . . . notch, **79c** . . . face, **79g** . . . inclined face, **79s** . . . face, **80** . . . wall part, **81** . . . front surface, **82** . . . rear surface, **83** . . . recessed part, **85, 85d** . . . power supply unit grip part,

86, 86a . . . first display part, **90, 90b, 90c, 90d** . . . mounting unit, **91, 91c, 91d** . . . mounting part, **92** . . . slide rail, **93** . . . positive input terminal, **94** . . . negative input terminal, **95** . . . lock receiving hole, **100, 100b** . . . battery pack, **101** . . . rail receiving part, **102** . . . positive output terminal, **103** . . . negative output terminal, **104** . . . connector part, **105** . . . lock member, **106** . . . unlock button, **110b** . . . battery body, **120b** . . . electric cord, **125b** . . . connection end part, **131** . . . first energizing terminal, **132** . . . second energizing terminal, **133** . . . bottom switch, **133c** . . . acceleration sensor, **134** . . . button, **135** . . . button receiver, **141** . . . sound output part, **150** . . . second display part, **151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158** . . . region, **S1** . . . main switch, **S2** . . . switch, **Tc** . . . temperature sensor

Claims

1. An electric kettle, comprising: a kettle body having a power receiving connection part configured to receive power from an external power source, and a heating part configured to heat liquid contained in the a power supply unit configured such that the kettle body is placed thereon, and configured to supply power to the kettle body, the power supply unit including: a power supply base configured such that the kettle body is placed on top thereof, the power supply base including a power supply connection part that is configured to be electrically removably connected to the power receiving connection part; a mounting unit configured such that a battery pack is removably coupled thereto as the external power source for supplying power to the heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part; and a first sensor configured to detect that the power supply unit is placed on a plane, wherein: an indicator configured to indicate drive information of the electric kettle; and a second controller configured to control the indicator based on a detection result of the first sensor, wherein: the second controller is configured to cause the indicator to indicate, as the drive information that the power supply unit is not on the plane when the power supply unit is not placed on the plane.
2. The electric kettle as defined in claim 1, wherein the first sensor includes a switch provided in a lower surface of the power supply unit, and the switch is configured to protrude from the lower surface when the power supply unit is not on the plane, while being pushed into the lower surface when the power supply unit is on the plane.
3. The electric kettle as defined in claim 1, further comprising: a first controller that is configured to control power supply to the heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part based on a detection result of the first sensor, wherein: the first controller supplies power supply to the heating part when at least one predetermined condition is satisfied, and does not supply power to the heating part when the at least one predetermined condition is not satisfied, and the at least one predetermined condition includes that the power supply unit is placed on the plane.
4. The electric kettle as defined in claim 3, further comprising a second sensor configured to detect that the kettle body is on the power supply base.
5. The electric kettle as defined in claim 4, wherein: the first controller is further configured to control power supply to the heating part based on a detection result of the second sensor, the at least one predetermined condition includes that the kettle body is on the power supply base.
6. The electric kettle as defined in claim 5, wherein the second controller is further configured to control the indicator based on a detection result of the second sensor, and to cause the indicator to indicate, as the drive information, that the kettle body is not on the power supply base when the kettle body is not on the power supply base.
7. The electric kettle as defined in claim 6, wherein: the first sensor includes a switch, the switch being provided in a lower surface of the power supply unit, and configured to protrude from the lower surface when the power supply unit is not on the plane, while being pushed into the lower surface when the power supply unit is on the plane, and the second controller is further configured

to detect a residual capacity of the battery pack via the mounting unit and to cause the indicator to indicate, as the drive information, that the residual capacity of the battery pack is not more than a predetermined residual capacity when the residual capacity of the battery pack is not more than the predetermined residual capacity.

8. The electric kettle as defined in claim 1, further comprising a second sensor configured to detect that the kettle body is on the power supply base.

9. The electric kettle as defined in claim 3, further comprising: a second sensor configured to detect that the kettle body is on the power supply base, wherein: the first controller is further configured to control power supply to the heating part based on a detection result of the second sensor, and the at least one predetermined condition includes that the kettle body is placed on the power supply base.

10. The electric kettle as defined in claim 1, further comprising: a second sensor configured to detect that the kettle body is on the power supply base, wherein: the second controller is further configured to control the indicator based on a detection result of the second sensor, and to cause the indicator to indicate, as the drive information that the kettle body is not on the power supply base when the kettle body is not placed on the power supply base.

11. The electric kettle as defined in claim 1, wherein the second controller is further configured to detect a residual capacity of the battery pack via the mounting unit and to cause the indicator, as the drive information, that the residual capacity of the battery pack is not more than a predetermined residual capacity when the residual capacity of the battery pack is not more than the predetermined residual capacity.

12. The electric kettle as defined in claim 1, wherein the power supply unit has a grip part that extends upward from the power supply base and is configured to be held by a user.

13. The electric kettle as defined in claim 12, wherein the power supply base and the mounting unit are respectively arranged on opposite sides of the grip part.

14. The electric kettle according to claim 1, wherein the indicator includes at least one of a first display part, a second display part, a sound output, a first switch and a second switch.

15. A power supply unit, which is configured such that a kettle body is placed thereon, and configured to supply power to the kettle body, comprising: a power supply base configured such that the kettle body is placed on top thereof, the power supply base including a power supply connection part that is configured to supply power to the kettle body; a mounting unit that is configured such that a battery pack is removably coupled thereto to supply power to the kettle body via the power supply connection part; a first sensor configured to detect that the power supply unit is on a plane; an indicator configured to indicate drive information of an electric kettle; and a second controller configured to control the indicator based on a detection result of the first sensor, wherein: the second controller is configured to cause the indicator to indicate, as the drive information that the power supply unit is not on the plane when the power supply unit is not placed on the plane.

16. An electric kettle, comprising: a kettle body having a power receiving connection part configured to receive power from an external power source, and a heating part configured to heat liquid contained in the kettle body by the power the power receiving connection part receives; and a power supply unit configured such that the kettle body is placed thereon, and configured to supply power to the kettle body, the power supply unit including: a power supply base configured such that the kettle body is placed on top thereof, the power supply base including a power supply connection part that is configured to be electrically removably connected to the power receiving connection part; a mounting unit configured such that a battery pack is removably coupled thereto as the external power source for supplying power to the heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part; and a sensor configured to detect that the power supply unit is placed on a plane, wherein: the sensor includes a switch provided in a lower surface of the power supply unit, and the switch is configured to protrude from the lower surface

when the power supply unit is not on the plane, while being pushed into the lower surface when the power supply unit is on the plane.

17. The electric kettle according to claim 16, further comprising: a first controller that is configured to control power supply to the heating part via the power supply connection part and the power receiving connection part based on a detection result of the sensor, wherein: the first controller supplies power supply to the heating part when at least one predetermined condition is satisfied, and does not supply power to the heating part when the at least one predetermined condition is not satisfied, and the at least one predetermined condition includes that the power supply unit is placed on the plane.
